

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Golden rules for interviews



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What is something you should always do in an interview? Why?
- What is something you shouldn't do in an interview? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can exchange complex information about my work.
- I can talk about deduction and speculate about the past.
- I can report what someone had previously said.





Let's Explore!

Mark gives Adam a few tips about interviews!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Mark:** So, you told me your interview game is not up to snuff. Why is that?
- Adam:** I don't know. I'm a little rough around the edges. I could've used your help before but you said you were busy so I didn't bother asking.
- Mark:** Come on, Adam! We're friends. You should've told me you were having issues. I would've taken some time to assist with interviews. You're earnest and eager, but you don't have the air of someone who can do it with one hand tied behind your back.
- Adam:** You're right. I could've called you. I just want to excel in my next interviews.
- Mark:** You will. And here's the first thing. Don't chew gum during the interview.
- Adam:** Got it. One recruiter at the job fair commented that it is rude. One thing I did at an interview was to say negative comments about my previous employer.
- Mark:** You shouldn't have said that. You could've mentioned that you left for personal reasons.
- Adam:** A friend suggested that I schedule my interviews in the morning.
- Mark:** Yes. A friend who works in HR observed that this is when you're likely to be successful and get the job.
- Adam:** I also brought up salary and benefits.
- Mark:** What? You could've kept your mouth shut. You should've waited until you got the job offer.
- Adam:** A friend remarked that I am always too early for the interview. I was one hour early for my last interview.
- Mark:** You should've waited downstairs or outside. My father claimed that turning up five to 10 minutes is the sweet spot for interviews.
- Adam:** I feel like I've learned so much from you.
- Mark:** You would've benefited more had you contacted me earlier. I know a few companies that are hiring. I'll put in good words for you.
- Adam:** Thanks. Now, if you'll excuse me, I need to ace my next interview.





Let's Practice!

Mark tells Adam what a friend told him!

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

suggested that I schedule / commented that / remarked that I am always /
observed that this is when / claimed that turning up

1. One recruiter at the job fair _____ it is rude to chew gum during an interview.
2. A friend _____ my interviews in the morning.
3. A friend who works in HR _____ you're likely to be successful and get the job.
4. A friend _____ too early for the interview.
5. My father _____ five to 10 minutes early is the sweet spot for interviews.



Let's Practice!

Help me get a job!

Instructions: Complete the sentence by selecting the correct phrase from the Word Bank.

Word Bank

ace / already of / rough around the edges / if you'll excuse me /
earnest / the air of / sweet spot / excel / hand tied behind your back

- 1) I'm a little _____.
- 2) You're _____.
- 3) You don't have _____ someone who can do it with one _____.
- 4) I just want to _____ in my next interview.
- 5) My father claimed that turning up 5 to 10 minutes is the _____ for interviews.
- 6) Now, _____, I need to _____ my next interview.





Extension Activity

Talk about the do's and dont's with a partner

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Brainstorm bad things people do in interviews. Write a list of at least 3 - 5 things.
- Write a dialogue between two people. One person is describing bad things they have done in an interview and the other is talking about things they could've, should've or would've done.
- When you are finished, read the dialogue to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about bad interview manners.

☐ ☐

I write a dialogue about the bad things that are done in interviews.

☐ ☐

I use modals for past speculation.

☐ ☐

I read my dialogue about an interview to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to not be up to snuff** (expression): to be not as good as it should be
e.g. You told me your interview game is not up to snuff.
- to be rough around the edges** (expression): not very sophisticated or unpolished
e.g. I'm a little rough around the edges and I could've used your help before but you were busy.
- earnest** (adjective): serious and determined
e.g. You're earnest and eager.
- to not have the air** (expression): a feeling or attitude that someone has
e.g. You don't have the air of someone who can do it alone.
- with one hand tied behind your back** (expression): to do something very easily
e.g. I know you can do it with one hand tied behind your back.
- to put in a good word** (expression): to tell someone about the good qualities a person has
e.g. I know a few companies that are hiring so I'll put in a good word for you.
- sweet spot** (noun): the best possible place or combination of factors
e.g. My father claimed that turning up five to 10 minutes early is the sweet spot for interviews.
- if you'll excuse me** (expression): to do very well
e.g. I aced my interview and got the job!
- ace an interview** (expression): to do very well
e.g. I aced my interview and got the job!





Learning Points

Speculating About The Past

When talking about unreal situations in the past, the third conditional is used. You can use *would have*, *should have* and *could have* to discuss hypothetical situations in the past.

a. *Could have* is used to express that a past action was possible and that the user could have done something, but didn't.

I could've used your help yesterday but I assumed you were busy. (= I had the chance to ask for your help but I didn't.)

b. *Should have* is used to express regret about something that was done or not done in the past.

You ***should've told*** me you were having issues. (= You didn't tell me but it was a good idea to tell me.)

I ***should've waited*** downstairs or outside. (=I regret not waiting downstairs or outside.)

c. *Would have* is used in the past to represent something that didn't occur.

You ***would've benefited*** more had you contacted me earlier (= You didn't contact me; therefore, you didn't benefit from my advice).

Examples:

- *I would've taken* some time to assist with interviews.
- *I could've called* you.
- You *shouldn't have* said that.
- You *could've mentioned* that you left for personal reasons.
- You *could've kept* your mouth shut.
- You *should've waited* until you got the job offer.





Learning Points

Reported Speech

You use reported speech when you are saying (reporting) what other people said.

When you tell people what someone has said in the past, you generally make the verb tense 'more in the past'. You need to change the verb to the next past form.

For example:

Direct speech

- *My interview game is not up to snuff.*

Reported speech

- *You told me your interview game was not up to snuff.*

When changing sentences from direct speech, check if you have to change the following:

- pronouns (I said → He said)
- Present tense verbs
- Place and time expressions
- Tenses (backshift → change to the past)

Some reporting verbs and expressions commonly used are: **say**, **tell**, and **ask**.

Other reporting verbs you can use are: **comment**, **suggest**, **observe**, **remark**, **claim**. All these verbs follow the pattern: subject + verb (ed) + that + clause.

Examples:

- You said you were busy so I didn't bother asking.
- One recruiter at the job fair commented that it is rude.
- A friend suggested that I schedule my interviews in the morning.
- A friend who works in HR observed that this is when you're likely to be successful and get the job.
- A friend remarked that I am always too early for the interview.
- My father claimed that turning up five to 10 minutes is the sweet spot for interviews.

